

making quick profits off newcomers, whether they are called *gaijin*, *gweilos*, *goyim*, or *gringos*. Our *emptors* had better *caveat*. The local man will be given the advantage, especially by the native bureaucracy. There is a common tendency to take care of your own and freeze out foreigners, whether by legal or illegal means. Exchange controls, special regulations, all sorts of ways are devised to hamper the foreigner.

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Locals always have an edge.

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We've all read stories about how difficult it is for a U.S. company to do well in Japan. I know what's happened in my own industry. U.S. mutual fund companies—Fidelity and several others of the giants—have been trying to market a product in Europe and the Far East for years and have found it very difficult, because each of these countries has its own financial institutions and doesn't relish the idea of competitors from outside. So they've found eleven open and fourteen devious ways to prevent this competition from occurring.

Eventually all this will probably change. The trend is to the one world economy we all hear and read about. But it is going to be frustratingly slow in coming.

There's a third reason that sticking to U.S. multinationals isn't the same as directly investing abroad: some foreign industries simply don't have counterparts in the United States. For instance, in Singapore you can invest in shipyard stocks. There aren't any shipyard stocks in the U.S. In Britain you can buy an airport management company. There's no such thing here. Many of these stocks are very good investments.

Oh, yes, there's one more reason, at least for people in my line of work: the travel is terrific.